SARA AHARON

Earth Observation Scientist & Geospatial Researcher

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PROFILE

Emerging Earth Observation scientist and geospatial researcher specializing in cloud-based spatial analysis, remote sensing applications, and environmental monitoring. Experienced in utilizing Google Earth Engine, QGIS, Sentinel-2, Landsat imagery, and VIIRS nighttime lights data to model urban expansion, green infrastructure dynamics, and coastal geomorphology. Authored award-winning national research and presented at international Earth Observation workshops.

EDUCATION & ACADEMIC HONORS

B.Sc. in Territorial Planning — **Oct 2024 – Present**

Alexandru Ioan Cuza University of Iași, Faculty of Geography and Geology | Iași, Romania

- Academic Merit Scholarship Recipient (2024–2025 & 2025–2026)
- 1st Prize - Top Student: Ranked 1st overall in Territorial Planning specialization (Year 1 & Year 2)

Academia RATIO XVI - Summer School — **Aug 2026 – Sept 2026**

Babeș-Bolyai University, Faculty of Economics and Business Administration | Cluj-Napoca, Romania

Erasmus+ BIP - Safe Mountain Explorer — **15–19 Jun 2026**

Wrocław University of Health and Sport Sciences | Wrocław, Poland

Just & Resilient Communities - Field Research Program — **16–23 May 2026**

Van Hall Larenstein Univ. (NL), ADR Nord-Est, & UAIC | Piatra Neamț, Romania

- Field research on community livelihoods to develop actionable policy recommendations for local authorities.

European Economic Studies — **Oct 2013 – Jun 2014**

Romanian-American University | Bucharest, Romania

RESEARCH PROJECTS & PUBLICATIONS

Cloud-Based Monitoring of 20 Years of Shoreline Change on Ko Phi Phi Don, Thailand — **Jun 2026 – Oct 2026**

PUBLICATION ORAL PRESENTATION

Publication: Aharon, S. (2026). Cloud-Based Monitoring of Twenty Years of Shoreline Change on Ko Phi Phi Don, Thailand, Using Google Earth Engine and Multi-Temporal Satellite Imagery. Proc. 6th Int. Electronic Conf. on Remote Sensing (ECRS 2026), MDPI, Basel, Switzerland.

- Executed a 20-year multi-temporal satellite analysis (2004–2024) utilizing Landsat and Sentinel-2 imagery in Google Earth Engine, QGIS, and ArcGIS. Integrated GIS transect analysis to quantify erosion/accretion patterns and evaluate tourism pressure impacts.

Earth Observation for Disaster Risk Management POSTER PRESENTATION — **16 Sept 2026**

Italian Space Agency (ASI) & CEOS WGD International Workshop | Rome, Italy

- Developed and presented a scientific research poster on satellite Earth Observation techniques applied to disaster risk assessment and environmental monitoring.

Spatio-Temporal Dynamics of Urban Green Infrastructure - Focșani Municipality (1990–2025) — **20 Nov 2025**

2ND PRIZE WINNER ORAL PRESENTATION

"Mihai David" National Student Symposium (15th Ed., UAIC Iași)

- Formulated a 35-year geospatial analysis of urban expansion and green space loss, establishing an inverse relationship between built-up density and urban vegetation cover for sustainable urban planning policy.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Operations Manager — Dead Freddies LLC June 2015 – Jan 2024
Ocean City, Maryland, United States

- Directed daily operations and led a multinational team in a high-volume hospitality venue.
- Developed high-level leadership, crisis management, cross-cultural communication, and operational problem-solving capabilities.

CONFERENCES, SYMPOSIA & WORKSHOPS

International Geographic Seminar "Dimitrie Cantemir" (46th Ed.) — UAIC Iași Oct 2026
Oral Presentation ORAL PRESENTATION

The 6th International Electronic Conference on Remote Sensing (ECRS 2026) — MDPI Oct 2026
Oral Presentation ORAL PRESENTATION

ASI-CEOS WGD Workshop on Earth Observation for Disaster Risk Management — Italian Space Agency (ASI), Rome, Italy Sept 2026
Scientific Poster Presentation POSTER PRESENTATION

JUST4MPA Hands-on Conference: Blue Justice and Social Equity for Marine Protected Areas — University of Bucharest Jun 2026
Participant PARTICIPANT

National Conference "George Vâlsan" — Babeș-Bolyai University, Cluj-Napoca May 2026
Oral Presentation ORAL PRESENTATION

Annual Scientific Communications Session (31st Ed.) — University of Craiova May 2026
Oral Presentation ORAL PRESENTATION

Hyperspectral Remote Sensing Workshop — Organized by ASI (Italy), DLR (Germany), ROSA (Romania) & POLITEHNICA Bucharest Apr 2026
Participant PARTICIPANT

BACKUP GISRS International Symposium (Spring Ed., 32nd Ed.) — UAIC Iași Mar 2026
Oral Presentation ORAL PRESENTATION

National Symposium of Student Geographers (32nd Ed.) — CCMESI & University of Bucharest Mar 2026
Oral Presentation ORAL PRESENTATION

geo-spatial.org Seminars (45th Ed.) — Chișinău, Republic of Moldova Mar 2026
Oral Presentation ORAL PRESENTATION

"Mihai David" National Student Symposium (15th Ed.) — UAIC Iași Nov 2025
Oral Presentation & 2nd Place Winner ORAL PRESENTATION 2ND PLACE WINNER

TELLURIA International Youth Conference for Earth Sciences & Humanities (2nd Ed.) — UAIC Iași Nov 2025
Oral Presentation ORAL PRESENTATION

Climate Change Summit 2025 — Palace of Parliament, Bucharest Oct 2025
Participant PARTICIPANT

CIVIC ENGAGEMENT & LEADERSHIP

Student Policy Delegate — Forum of Romanian Students Worldwide Sept 2025
Ministry of Labour, Family, Youth and Social Solidarity & Union of Romanian Students | Bucharest, Romania

- Collaborated with student delegates from Romania and the diaspora to draft consensus-based youth policy recommendations for formal ministerial consideration.

Environmental Fieldwork & Documentary Contributor — V.O.T.C.A. Project Sept 2025
Ministry of Labour, Family, Youth and Social Solidarity & ETH Student League | Vatra Dornei, Suceava, Romania

- Participated in mountain environmental field evaluations and documentary film production (Vreau O Țară Ca Afară, 2025) assessing ecological conditions and community impact.

Youth Mentor & Cultural Guide — ARC Camps **Aug 2024**

Department for Romanians Everywhere (Government of Romania) | Tulnici, Vrancea, Romania

- Guided and mentored 50 youth from the Romanian diaspora in Ukraine and Moldova during a one-week cultural exchange program focused on heritage and identity reconnection.

TECHNICAL SKILLS & LANGUAGES

GIS & Remote Sensing:	QGIS, ArcGIS, Google Earth Engine, Landsat, Sentinel-2, Copernicus, NDVI, NDWI, NDBI, LST, Aerial/UAV Imagery
Data & Development:	Python, SQL, VS Code, HTML, CSS, GitHub Pages, Geospatial Data Analysis
Soft Skills:	Research Analysis, Leadership, Teamwork
Language Proficiency:	**Romanian:** Native | **English:** C1 (Fluent) | **Spanish:** Intermediate | **German:** Beginner

PROFESSIONAL CERTIFICATIONS

GIS, Remote Sensing & Cartography

- **ESRI:** GIS for Climate Action (Mar 2026)
- **ESRI:** Going Places with Spatial Analysis (Feb 2026)
- **ESRI:** GIS Basics (Feb 2026)
- **ESRI:** The ArcGIS Imagery MOOC: Foundations and Frontiers (Nov 2025)
- **ESRI:** Cartography (Oct 2025)
- **ESRI:** Make an Impact with Modern Geo Apps (May 2025)
- **NASA:** Fundamentals of Remote Sensing (Nov 2025)

Climate, Nature & Conservation

- **IUCN Academy:** Synthetic Biology in Relation to Nature Conservation (Aug 2026)
- **IUCN Academy:** Introduction to Mapping Biodiversity Priorities (Aug 2026)
- **IUCN Academy:** Introduction to Finance for Nature (Aug 2026)
- **IUCN Academy:** Introduction to Conservation and Agriculture (Aug 2026)
- **IUCN Academy:** Introduction to Cities and Nature (Aug 2026)
- **IUCN Academy:** Introduction to Conservation and Climate Change (Aug 2026)
- **IUCN Academy:** United for Nature and Society (Aug 2026)
- **IUCN Academy:** Nature's Crown Jewels: An Introduction to Nature World Heritage (Aug 2026)
- **RECOFTC:** Community Forestry 101 (Jul 2026)
- **HP Foundation:** Circular Economy (May 2025)

Data, AI & Open Science

- **Esri on AWS:** The Rise of GeoAI (Feb 2026)
- **NASA:** NASA Open Science 101 (Feb 2026)
- **NASA:** NASA Open Science Essentials (Feb 2026)
- **AWS:** Fundamentals of Machine Learning and Artificial Intelligence (Jan 2026)
- **Google Cloud Training:** Intro to Generative AI (Jan 2026)
- **HP Foundation:** Data Science & Analytics (May 2025)

Aviation & Technical Qualifications

- **EASA:** A1/A3 Open Sub Category Drone Pilot License (Valid to Dec 2030)
- **ICDL/ECDL Romania:** IT Skills Certification (Jan 2010)